

Reza Lavassani

Born in 1962 in Tehran, Iran, Reza Lavassani received his BA in painting from University of Tehran's Faculty of Fine Arts in 1991.

Lavassani's interest in mythology, sociology, religion and history has allowed him to spend years studying philosophy and mysticism. As a painter and a sculptor, his creations are directly influenced by these interests through visual interpretations of Persian literature and poetry. Being fascinated by the past-explicitly the literature and poetry of that era-he interprets his subjects in a contemporary manner by means of imagination.

Lavassani creates designs that are strongly recognizable as "Lavassani's" creations. First and foremost, he is focused on drawings which can then turn into either paintings or sculptures. A well-thought-through process, Lavassani draws and paints a blueprint of each work before he starts on the actual piece. He mainly uses oil on canvas for his paintings and papier-mâché for his sculptures. In them, he presents fable-like trees, winds, waves, horses, and musical instruments which are uniquely his and even though they don't resemble reality, they all possess a sense of poetic realness.

Lavassani has held several solo exhibitions in Iran and has been part of numerous national and international group exhibitions and art fairs. He has been the recipient of several awards including UNESCO's Noma Concourse in 2007 and 1994 and the first prize of Tehran's 4th Biennial of Sculpture and 6th Biennial of Illustration. His work has also been included in a number of publications inside and outside Iran in addition to being part of several important private collections. In 2019 he was represented in national pavilion of Iran in La Biennale di Venezia with his installation "Life".